



Ethicare
Resourcing

NEW ZEALAND RESOURCE CENTRE · COMPANION CHECKLIST

Psychology (NZPB) Registration Checklist

A practical, tickable checklist to work through alongside your New Zealand Psychologists Board Registration Guide — so nothing gets missed on the way to registration.



Before you begin

Tick as you go

Tick each box on screen as you complete it. The items are grouped into stages, roughly in the order you'll tackle them — but you can work on several at once. This checklist is a companion to the main guide, which explains the *why* behind each step. It complements, and does not replace, the official guidance of the New Zealand Psychologists Board, who make all registration decisions.

01 Before you start

Get oriented before you spend money or gather documents.

- ☐ **Complete the Board's online Self-Assessment of Eligibility**
Your essential first step — an early read on fitness, equivalence and competence
- ☐ **Confirm which of the seven scopes fits your training**
Psychologist, Clinical, Counselling, Educational, Neuropsychologist, Intern, Trainee
- ☐ **Check you hold registration where you trained AND where you live**
Both are required; if you can't register where you trained, NZ is unlikely
- ☐ **Check the in-residence requirement**
Min one continuous year in residence — online/weekend-only/summer-intensive programmes don't qualify
- ☐ **Note the current fees**
Non-refundable; differ for prescribed vs non-prescribed countries — check the Board's live page

02 Internship evidence (start this first!)

The 1500-hour requirement — the most scrutinised part of your application.

- ☐ **Evidence of 1500+ supervised practice hours**
Structured, supervised, formally evaluated — part of your qualification
- ☐ **Show ≥50% in service-related activities**
Treatment, assessment, interviews, report writing, case presentations, consultations
- ☐ **Show ≥25% of total hours in direct client contact**
Half of the service-related activities
- ☐ **Show supervision: 2 hrs/week (1 hr individual, in-person)**
By a licensed psychologist
- ☐ **Confirm hours count from semi-independent practice onward**
Early practica generally don't count toward the 1500

03 Qualifications & registration

What the Board assesses for equivalence.

- ☐ **Evidence of a minimum 6-year course of studies**
In psychology
- ☐ **Full course content — undergrad and postgrad**
Especially detailed if you trained outside UK/South Africa/USA
- ☐ **Evidence your programme is accredited**
- ☐ **Endpoint evaluation or licensing exam evidence**
- ☐ **Proof of current registration/licensure**
With a recognised state or national authority, in good standing
- ☐ **Evidence for each scope you apply under**
Qualifications, internships and training specific to that scope

04 Identity & references

Confirming who you are and that you're fit and proper.

- ☐ **Certified identity documents**
Plus name-change evidence if your name differs across documents
- ☐ **Translations of any non-English documents**
Certified
- ☐ **At least one senior overseas-registered referee**
Registered/chartered/licensed — include a copy of their registration certificate
- ☐ **References original, signed, dated within 3 months**
Or emailed by the referee directly to the Board, with your name in the subject
- ☐ **Referees have known you 12+ months**
Professionally; family and friends are not suitable

05 Criminal history

Police records with precise rules — easy to get slightly wrong.

- ☐ **Police record from each country lived in 5+ years**
Any country you lived in for more than 3 months in the past 5 years
- ☐ **Requested directly from the police**
Third-party pre-employment checks are NOT accepted
- ☐ **No more than 6 months old, all names included**
- ☐ **Explanatory letter if you have any conviction**
A conviction isn't an automatic bar — disclose fully and explain

06 English language (if required)

Only if English isn't your first language AND quals weren't in English in AU/CA/ZA/UK/IE/US.

- ☐ **Sit IELTS Academic (the only accepted test)**
Required only if the above applies to you
- ☐ **Meet 7.5 overall with no less than 7.0 each section**
A high bar — prepare evenly across all four
- ☐ **Results obtained within the last 2 years**
Time it so they're still valid at submission
- ☐ **Consider IELTS One Skill Retake if you miss one section**
The Board accepts One Skill Retake results

07 Cultural competence (get ahead of it)

Begin before you relocate — it helps with any transitional condition.

- ☐ **Review the Board's Cultural Competence information**
Understand te Tiriti o Waitangi and Māori health expectations
- ☐ **Start the Foundation Course in Cultural Competency**
Free and optional — learnonline.health.nz
- ☐ **Consider the Mauri Ora (Māori) cultural course**
Specifically recommended by the Board — mauriora.co.nz
- ☐ **Note a transitional condition may apply**
Common for those new to NZ — it's designed to support you, not penalise you

08 Submit & after

Putting it together and what follows.

- ☐ **Assemble everything as a clean, organised application**
Clear colour scans, certified where needed, well named
- ☐ **Pay the (non-refundable) application fee**
Confirm the current figure for your country first
- ☐ **Submit to the Board**
Individual assessment of fitness, equivalence and competence follows
- ☐ **Respond promptly to any Board queries**
Speed of response is the biggest factor within your control
- ☐ **Registration confirmed (scope may carry a transitional condition)**
- ☐ **Apply for your Annual Practising Certificate (APC)**
Required before you can practise

HOW ETHICARE WILL SUPPORT YOU

You don't have to do this alone

If anything on this checklist raises a question, that's exactly what we're here for. We support and guide you through every stage — from first enquiry to starting work. The registration decision always rests with the New Zealand Psychologists Board.

READY TO BEGIN?

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This checklist is provided for general information to support internationally qualified professionals and complements, but does not replace, the official guidance of the New Zealand Psychologists Board. All registration requirements and decisions rest with the Board. Requirements can change — always check the Board's current published guidance before acting.



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